

PROJECT PROPOSAL

CaseFlow: Student Disciplinary Case Management System

A Web-Based System for Managing Student Disciplinary Cases

1. Introduction

This project proposes a web-based system, CaseFlow, that digitizes and streamlines the management of student disciplinary cases — from incident reporting through committee review, decision, suspension enforcement, and eventual re-integration of the student.

2. Problem Statement

- Disciplinary committees take a long time to physically sit and reach decisions on reported cases.
- Decisions (e.g. semester suspension) often arrive late — sometimes after the student has already registered for and started the following semester.
- Students sometimes lose marks without clarity on whether their case was ever formally confirmed or what the final decision was.
- Students have no way to track the status of their own disciplinary case.
- When a suspended student seeks re-integration, there is no reliable record proving the suspension occurred, its duration, or whether it was actually served — making verification difficult for the committee.

3. Objectives

- Enable lecturers/invigilators to report incidents (e.g. exam cheating) digitally and instantly.
- Allow the disciplinary committee to review, discuss, and decide on cases without requiring everyone to physically meet at once.
- Ensure decisions are recorded and enforced in time, before the next semester registration opens.
- Give students full visibility into the status and outcome of their own case.
- Maintain a permanent, verifiable disciplinary record for every confirmed case, including suspension start/end dates, to support fair and accurate re-integration.

4. Proposed System Overview

CaseFlow operates across four user roles: Lecturer/Invigilator, Disciplinary Committee Member, Student, and Registrar/Admin. The system manages the complete case lifecycle: Report → Review → Decision → Enforcement → Re-integration, with every stage timestamped and recorded for transparency and audit purposes.

5. Key Features

- Incident reporting form for lecturers, with evidence attachment (e.g. exam scripts, photos).
- Online committee review workspace — members can view evidence, comment, and vote/decide remotely without an in-person sitting.
- Automatic case status tracker visible to the student (Reported → Under Review → Decided → Resolved).
- Automated alerts to the Registrar before semester registration opens, flagging any student with a pending or active suspension.
- Permanent digital disciplinary record per student, storing offense type, decision, suspension start and end dates, and decision date.
- Re-integration verification module — committee can look up a student's record to confirm suspension dates before approving return, with automatic flags if a student attempts to re-register before their suspension period ends.
- Appeal option for students who wish to contest a decision.
- Admin dashboard for reporting on case volumes, average resolution time, and suspension records.

6. Proposed Technology

Frontend: React.js | Backend: Node.js (Express) | Database: PostgreSQL | Authentication: JWT with role-based access (Lecturer, Committee, Student, Admin) | Notifications: SMS and Email.

7. Expected Impact

Faster case resolution, timely enforcement of decisions before semester start, full transparency for students, and a reliable, auditable disciplinary record that makes re-integration fair, fast, and verifiable — addressing a real and recurring problem on campus.